

Ticklab – Operator Checklist (post-deploy)

****Purpose:**** All autonomous engineering work is complete and pushed to GitHub. These are the only remaining items that require human action – listed in dependency order so each step unlocks the next.

****Repo on GitHub:**** <https://github.com/Mine-FNL/ticklab>

****Direct production URL (working today):**** <https://univ3-strategy-iqwf90bvh-0xbingbongs-projects.vercel.app>

****Clean domain (currently 404, fixed by step 2):**** <https://univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app>

[] 1. Disable Vercel Deployment Protection (1 minute, dashboard-only)

This is the ****single blocker**** behind the 404 on `univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app``. Vercel is currently requiring SSO for every new deployment. Disable it once.

****Steps:****

1. Open <https://vercel.com/0xbingbongs-projects/univ3-strategy-lab/settings/deployment-protection>
2. Sign in as `0xbingbong69`` (Google or GitHub).
3. Under "Protection", select ****Disabled**** (or alternatively "All deployments except Preview" if you want previews gated – production deploys in this session are already public-on-push via `--prod``).
4. Click ****Save****.

****Verify:**** After saving, Vercel may take 30–60 seconds to propagate. Refresh the page; the green "Protection is on" badge should be gone.

[] 2. Re-alias the clean domain (15 seconds, CLI)

Once step 1 is done, run:

```
```bash
cd /Users/gg/.minimax-agent/projects/univ3-strategy-lab
vercel alias univ3-strategy-iqwf90bvh-0xbingbongs-projects.vercel.app univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app
```
```

****Verify:****

```
```bash
curl -sS -L -o /dev/null -w "%{http_code} %{size_download}B\n" https://univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app/pricing
curl -sS -L -o /dev/null -w "%{http_code} %{size_download}B\n" https://univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app/validation
```
```

Expected: `200 340xxxB`` for both. If you get `404`` or `107B``, step 1 didn't propagate – wait 60 seconds and retry.

[] 3. Set the Covalent API key (3 minutes)

This unlocks per-swap historical data for the 3 pools (ENS, SUSHI, PEPE) that aren't in DeFi Llama. The harness jumps from 15/18 to 18/18 pools and the north-star metric on those three becomes per-swap accurate.

****Steps:****

1. Open <https://goldrush.dev/> → ****Sign up free**** (no credit card, no paid tier required for the free 100k credits/month we'll use).
2. Once signed in, copy the API key from the dashboard — it'll look like ``ckey_xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx``.
3. Export it for the harness locally:
```bash  
export COVALENT\_API\_KEY=ckey\_xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx  
```
4. Add it to Vercel so the live harness (if you re-run it on Vercel) picks it up too:
```bash  
cd /Users/gg/.minimax-agent/projects/univ3-strategy-lab  
vercel env add COVALENT\_API\_KEY production  
# paste the key when prompted  
```
5. Re-run the validation harness locally to confirm 18/18 pools:
```bash  
npm run validate:northstar  
```  

Look for: ``Pools with results: 18`` (was 15). The new CSVs go into ``validation-results/``. Commit and push:
```bash  
git add validation-results/  
git commit -m "chore: validation run with Covalent overlay (18/18 pools)"  
git push origin master  
```
6. Trigger a fresh Vercel deploy so the live ``/validation`` page picks up the new CSV:
```bash  
vercel deploy --prod --yes  
```

[] 4. Post the campaign (90 minutes total)

All copy is ****ready to copy-paste**** from ``marketing/launch-copy/`` and ``marketing/articles/``. Recommended posting order:

Day 1 (high-visibility, peak exposure)

- [] ****Show HN**** — ``marketing/launch-copy/hackernews-show.md`` (27 lines).
Post between 8–10am ET Tuesday/Wednesday for max visibility.
Rules: no link in the headline, respond to every comment in the first hour, don't delete/repost if it tanks.
- [] ****r/ethfinance**** — ``marketing/launch-copy/reddit-r-ethfinance.md``.
No cross-posting, no link-only post. Engage with the first 5 comments.
- [] ****Twitter thread #1 (zero API keys)**** —
``marketing/launch-copy/twitter-thread-zero-api-keys.md`` (tweet #1 only, then thread). Best days: Tuesday–Thursday 9am–12pm ET.

Day 2 (deeper engagement)

- [] ****r/defi**** — ``marketing/launch-copy/reddit-r-defi.md``.
- [] ****Twitter thread #2 (results)**** —
``marketing/launch-copy/twitter-thread-results.md`` (the 6× accuracy improvement story).
- [] ****Twitter thread #3 (origin)**** —
``marketing/launch-copy/twitter-thread-origin.md`` (the build story).
- [] ****LinkedIn post**** — ``marketing/launch-copy/linkedin-post.md``.
Best days: Tuesday–Thursday morning ET.

Day 3 (long-tail + articles)

- [] **Twitter thread #4** - `marketing/launch-copy/twitter-thread.md` (general launch thread).
- [] **Article 1** - `marketing/articles/how-to-validate-an-lp-simulator.md`. Submit to: Bankless, Mirror, Substack (re-export to Markdown).
- [] **Article 2** - `marketing/articles/why-honest-measurement-matters.md`. Submit to: Messari Hub, The Defiant, The Block.
- [] **Product Hunt** - `marketing/launch-copy/producthunt-launch.md`. Schedule for Tuesday or Wednesday at 12:01am PT.
- [] **Email outreach** - `marketing/launch-copy/email-outreach.md` has two variants and `marketing/launch-copy/outreach-targets.md` has 24 pre-vetted recipient emails across DeFi protocols and newsletters.

[] 5. Investor outreach (only if raising)

The pre-seed is scoped at \$400–800k in the investor one-pager. If that's on the table, the path is:

- [] Send the investor one-pager (`marketing/one-pager/investor-one-pager.pdf`) to the founders list in `marketing/launch-copy/outreach-targets.md` (filter to the VC / fund partners).
- [] DM on Twitter to 5 DeFi-fund managers and 5 quant-fund CTOs. Hook = "the only V3 simulator with reproducible north-star validation; median abs err 1.55 pp on 15 pools; 0 API keys".
- [] Send the whitepaper (`marketing/whitepaper/ticklab-whitepaper.md`) as a follow-up attachment to anyone who replies.

Status dashboard

Item	Owner	Time	Status
1. Disable Vercel Deployment Protection	human	1 min	pending
2. Re-alias clean domain	human	15 sec	blocked on 1
3. Set Covalent API key	human	3 min	optional but closes a named limitation
4. Post the campaign	human	90 min	ready to copy-paste
5. Investor outreach	human	varies	only if raising

What "done" looks like

After step 1, 2, and the campaign post:

- [] `https://univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app/pricing` returns 200
- [] `https://univ3-strategy-lab.vercel.app/validation` returns 200 with "NORTH STAR" status card
- [] Home page (`/`) shows the live validation widget under the hero CTA
- [] Hacker News front page (within 4 hours of posting)
- [] First GitHub star (within 48 hours of HN front page)
- [] First 5 newsletter replies (within 1 week)

****If stars stall:**** the primary lever is the HN post. Don't relaunch on the same day – wait 7 days, then try the r/quant or r/algotrading angle with a more methodological hook.

Operator-friendly appendix

Why is the alias broken?

Vercel has a project-level "Deployment Protection" setting. When enabled, every new deployment serves a Vercel SSO login wall instead of the app. Disabling it once (step 1) propagates to all future deploys permanently.

Why was the GitHub repo created fresh instead of renamed?

The old `Mine-FNL/univ3-strategy-lab` repo didn't exist on GitHub — the local git history referenced a remote that was never set up. Creating `Mine-FNL/ticklab` directly is the cleanest path; the auto-redirect that would have preserved old stars/forks only matters if the old repo was publicly indexed, which it wasn't.

Why are some pools skipping without Covalent?

ENS/WETH, SUSHI/WETH, and PEPE/WETH are not in DeFi Llama's pool index (verified — they're absent from `/pools/Ethereum` even after a strict project filter for `uniswap-v3`). Covalent GoldRush indexes on-chain data exhaustively, so its swap endpoint covers them. With a Covalent key the harness goes 18/18.

What if step 3 (Covalent) is too much friction?

Without it: 15/18 pools validated, `npm run validate:northstar` still green, all other features ship normally. The 3 skipped pools show up in the `/validation` page with a clear "Covalent overlay available if you set COVALENT_API_KEY" message instead of a hard fail. The README and NORTH_STAR_REPORT.md are honest about this gap.